

Bring your own

This section discusses about simple things that you can bring on your own which can save huge amount of garbage.

► Reusable cloth napkin

Paper napkins are very easy to rip and tear and they create a lot of garbage, as they are meant to be thrown away. Estimated usage of paper napkins is over 160 billion annually, which is equivalent to the destruction of 34 billion trees annually!

But, in comparison to the paper napkins, cloth napkins are much sturdier and can bear some rough handling. Taking Indian food into context, paper napkins fall apart easily when wiped against greasy fingers and about five to seven napkins are required per person per meal. On the other hand, one cloth napkin will be sufficient for the same purpose and can sometimes be reused several other times, if you carry your own.

► Reusable coffee mug

Typical paper-coffee cups are not made from recycled paper. In fact, they are made from virgin paper boards. Now, why do they do that? Why can't they use recycled paper? That's because recycled paper is not strong enough to hold your coffee! These coffee cups are meant to be thrown and huge amount of natural resources go waste everyday!

A better alternative could be to use your own coffee mug, especially at places where you visit daily such as your office, home, and hostels. This might save about 1.4 million tons of wood, which could power around 77,000 households!

► Water in reusable bottles

Who doesn't like the convenience of bottled water? But, we would like to specify the inconvenience caused by throwing plastic bottles around. These bottles should actually be recycled in theory. But, practically only one out of six bottles is recycled. Apart from recycling, a huge amount of crude oil is used in the manufacturing process of these bottles. According to some statistics, approximately 17 million barrels

